DOMINICAN UNIVERSITY
Office of Career Programs & Employer Relations

Career & Vocation Planning & Goal Setting

This guide is meant to be used every year in residence at DU to highlight growth and updated accomplishments, choices, plans, and/or goals. Add the growth and updated goals each year; do not delete your previous year's input. Values and traits are usually more stable over time. It's exciting to see one's growth over time. We expect growth – if not, please talk with your advisor, a professor, or other trusted DU personnel to create an updated success plan as soon as possible.

Instructions: Download this guide to your computer as a Word or Google document. This is a critical assignment for each CV class, and you will upload it into your Wix ePortfolio for easy access. Please date each of your content entries.

CV 300: 9/22/2025

CV 400: 9/21/2026

Who I Am

Core Interests:
(e.g., Solving problems, helping others, building things, teaching, leading teams)

CV 100:

CV 200:

CV 300: My core interests are solving problems, technology, and contributing to a good cause.

CV 400: My core interests are solving problems, working with technology and systems, and contributing to organizations that do good work/a good cause.

Core Values:
(e.g., Integrity, innovation, community, financial security, lifelong learning)

CV 100:

CV 200:

CV 300: My core values are family, lifelong learning, and financial security.

CV 400: My core values are family, stability, and financial security.

Skills & Strengths:
(e.g., Communication, leadership, technical proficiency, project management, creativity)

CV 100:

CV 200:

CV 300: My skills and strengths are problem solving, taking initiative and flexibility.

CV 400: My skills and strengths remain problem solving, flexibility, and I have worked more on my communication.

Key Personal Traits:
(These are your power (i.e. soft) skills e.g., Analytical, creative, driven, collaborative)

CV 100:

CV 200:

CV 300: My key personal traits are being driven and detailed oriented.

CV 400: My key personal traits are being driven, detail oriented, and adaptable.

Preferred Work Environment:
(e.g., Competitive, mission-driven, structured, fast-paced)

CV 100:

CV 200:

CV 300: My preferred work environment is one that is structured and has clear expectations.

CV 400: My preferred work environment remains one that is structured, has clear expectations, and has flexibility for me to enjoy life outside of work.

Specific Goals | Areas for Growth in the "Who I Am" Category This Year:
(e.g., International experience, industry exposure, technical skills; Be as specific as possible)

CV 100:

CV 200:

CV 300: Developing technical skills (specifically coding languages such as APIs, Python, C#, and Java) and getting exposure to the industry through an internship.

CV 400: Continue developing technical skills as I want to learn more about IT and data analysis. Get a role in technology and also expand on my personal projects to have something to show for and gain experience.

Completed Education & Training

	CV 100	CV 200	CV 300	CV 400 (in the semester you are graduating)
Specific Degree			B.S. in Computer Science	B.S. in Computer Science
Specific Certification or Badge			No badges or specific certification gained during	No badges or specific certification gained
Academic Skills*			Java, Python, Database (SQL), C#,	Java, Python, Database (SQL), C#, Unity, Web Dev.
Competencies**			Problem solving, flexibility, attention to detail	Problem solving, flexibility, attention to detail, communication

*Skills: What you know or have learned.

** Competencies: Broader capabilities that combine skills, knowledge, and behaviors; Evidence of that you can do with what you know. are broader capabilities that combine skills, knowledge, and behaviors. They represent your capacity to perform effectively in a role. Competencies take time to develop and are often more context-specific than skills. They represent the "how" of using skills to achieve results. (e.g., Strategic thinking, problem-solving, leadership, communication, adaptability).

Employment History & Key Experience (Including Volunteer and Co-Curricular Activities)

Role	Organization	Dates	Achievements | Skills Gained
Payroll Assistant	After School Matters	June 2025 - Present	Leadership

Payroll Intern	After School Matters	June 2024 – June 2025	Teamwork, excel, communication
Volunteer Excel Tutor	Erie Neighborhood House	January 2024 - April 2024	Taking initiative, lesson planning
Application (Game) Development Intern	Duct Tape Games	January 2026 – March 2026	Experience in software development project with a small team, exposure to Unity and C#, experience working in a fully remote environment

Current Competencies, Skills & Interests

Technical Skills & Tools:
(e.g., Excel, data analysis, modeling, coding, project management)
CV 100:

CV 200:

CV 300: Proficient in Excel, coding skills (Python, Java, C#), and daily use of Microsoft 365 applications (Word, PowerPoint, and Outlook)

CV 400: Proficient in Excel, coding skills (Python, Java, C#, HTML, CSS), and daily use of Microsoft 365 applications (Word, PowerPoint, and Outlook), Zendesk, Box and ADP Workforce. Also worked with Raspberry Pi, Arduino, and Flask (Python) on a hardware/software project.

Power (Soft) Skills & Strengths:
(e.g., Communication, leadership, collaboration, problem-solving)
CV 100:

CV 200:

CV 300: Leadership, communication, problem solving

CV 400: Communication, leadership, problem solving, adaptability

Industries of Interest:
(e.g., Finance, healthcare, sustainability, education, tech)
CV 100:

CV 200:

CV 300: Finance and technology

CV 400: Has remained in finance and technology

Jobs of Interest:
(e.g., Job titles)
CV 100:

CV 200:

CV 300: Software developer, web developer, information technology position

CV 400: Software developer, web developer, information technology position, data analyst

Other Interests:
(e.g., Innovation, global affairs, entrepreneurship, research)
CV 100:

CV 200:

CV 300: Still exploring specific areas of interest beyond my core studies and open to new ideas. Personal interests include music.

CV 400: Music, fashion, and contributing to causes that help my community, like my current role helping teens across Chicago get paid for after school programs.

Career & Life Goals

Short-Term (0–2 Years)
- Career Goal:
(e.g., Secure a role in [field] with room for growth)

CV 100:

CV 200:

CV 300: Secure an internship in tech field for graduation and experience.

CV 400: Secure a full-time role in IT, software development, or technical operations after graduation.

- Personal Goal:
(e.g., Travel, deepen relationships, health goals)

CV 100:

CV 200:

CV 300: Attend more music festivals and events.

CV 400: Travel more, marriage, more active lifestyle (prioritize gym), attend more music festivals, shows and concerts, start driving more and buy myself a car.

Mid-Term (2–5 Years)
- Career Goal:
(e.g., Advance into a management or specialist role)

CV 100:

CV 200:

CV 300: Secure a full-time job in the technology field

CV 400: Secure a full-time role in IT operations or a related tech field and build experience in that area.

- Personal Goal:
(e.g., Relocate, pursue long-term commitments)

CV 100:

CV 200:

CV 300: Move out from home and in with my partner

CV 400: Move in with my boyfriend (hopefully husband by then)

Long-Term (5+ Years)
- Career Goal:
(e.g., Lead a business unit, start a company, earn executive role)

CV 100:

CV 200:

CV 300: Secure a role with more leadership responsibilities and have more influence on direction of projects

CV 400: Remains to secure a role with more leadership responsibilities and have more influence on direction of projects (and higher pay)

- Personal Goal:
(e.g., Financial security, family support, community impact)
CV 100:

CV 200:

CV 300: Financial security, Marriage, Family

CV 400: Financial security, marriage, family

Development Needs & Skill-Building Goals

Skill | Knowledge Desired	How to Develop It	By Goal Date
More experience with GitHub	Using online resources to help navigate	Dec. 2025
More experience with python	Find online course, and work on personal projects	Dec. 2025
Networking	Reaching out to classmates and going to career related events	Feb. 2026 and forward
Cloud computing	Complete beginner certification courses	May 2026
Time Management	Use calendar and planning tools more often	Nov. 2025

Action Plan: Next Steps (6–12 Months)

Goal | Task	Timeline	Status as of this Writing
(e.g., Complete internship, conducts 3 career conversations (informational interviews), attend industry networking event, update LinkedIn and resume, apply to 5 target companies)		
Secure an internship	By Summer 2026	Started applying to internships and will attend school career fair; Completed application development internship during Spring term at Duct Tape Games
Work on more coding projects to build portfolio	By Summer 2026	Learning how to use GitHub to upload code Worked on a project for class using Raspberry Pi and Arduino and got experience with developing embedded systems. Still need to work on more personal projects
Prepare for technical interviews	By March 2026	Purchased book recommended by prof. Will be reading it

		Still haven't finished the book, but I got some real interview experience by sitting in and helping my manager interview candidates for intern positions during the summer.

Reflection & Notes Section

Use this section to reflect on progress, note key conversations, record achievements, or update your thinking about your career path.
CV 100:

CV 200:

CV 300: Got a role as a payroll assistant from my payroll intern role, taking CS internship role more seriously, considering career in software development

CV 400: Shifted my job search focus toward IT support and operations roles rather than pure software development after I got clearer sense of where my strengths fit and with the experience I have as a payroll assistant. Took on more responsibility at After School Matters, tracking more logs and records and more cross departmental communication. Have also been tailoring resumes for roles (IT ops, business analyst, data analyst).